



CLFMUN

MODEL UNITED NATIONS | EDITION

— — — — —

STUDY GUIDE

US CONGRESS

— — — — —

Agentes del Cambio



CLFMUN 2026
115th United States Senate
2017 - Hillary Clinton's Administration



Letter of the President of the Senate:

Welcome, Esteemed Senators,

It is an honour to serve as the President of the Senate for the US Congress Historical English Committee at *Colegio Las Fuentes Model of the United Nations First Edition*. I have been a witness to how hard the Senior Staff have worked on this upcoming conference, for your enjoyment. As an external invitee to Lara's MUN Circuit, I seek to uphold the great principles of Diplomacy, Scholarship, and Leadership under which I have been formed in Valencia, Carabobo.

As you don't know me or my style as a delegate in MUN, I'll briefly describe what I seek as you delegates in three words: *Logic, Strategy, and Passion*. As of logic, seek logical and peaceful alternatives to solve problems not only within the committee but also between people. As of strategy, ALWAYS have a purpose for what you're doing, regardless of how small it is, understand what you are doing and why you are doing it. Finally, and for me, the most important, Passion, act with passion, enjoy what you are doing, make others enjoy it, and debate with the highest fervor evident in the society we represent while withholding respect and humility.

This committee isn't supposed to be the easiest, regardless if this is your first Model-UN conference or you have greater experience, give the most of yourself, and don't be scared to ask. Remember, the future of your constituents as Senators is in your hands.

See you soon,

Alejandro Sosa - President of the Senate

Letter of the President Pro-Tempore:

It is an honour to serve as the President of the Senate for the US Congress Historical English Committee at Colegio Las Fuentes Model of the United Nations First Edition. I have witnessed the tremendous effort the Senior Staff have dedicated to making this conference an enriching and memorable experience for all participants. As an external invitee to Lara's MUN Circuit, I seek to uphold the principles of Diplomacy, Scholarship, and Leadership under which I was formed in Valencia, Carabobo.

Since many of you may not know me or my style as a delegate, I would simply like to encourage all of you to make the most out of this committee. Have fun with the experience, challenge yourselves, and take every opportunity to learn something new, whether through debate, teamwork, or the exchange of ideas with others.

This committee is not meant to be easy. Whether this is your first Model United Nations conference or you already have extensive experience, I encourage you to give your best effort, participate actively, and never hesitate to ask questions.

Remember that, as Senators, the future of your constituents rests in your hands. See you soon

David Orozco-President Pro-Tempore

Letter of the Conference Officer:

Esteemed Senators,

It is a pleasure to welcome you to the U.S. Congress at **CLFMUN I Edition**. I am Isabella Marullo, and I will be your Conference Officer. As a member of the CLFMUN delegation, I am honored to be right there on the floor with you, making sure this committee runs as smoothly as possible.

While you navigate the political stakes of 2017, my focus is on the room's efficiency and procedural integrity. I am here to manage the technical framework of the floor, ensuring that the legislative process moves without unnecessary delays. My goal is to maintain a high-standard environment where every motion and document is handled with the precision that a congressional setting requires, allowing the debate to remain the priority.

Throughout our sessions, I will focus on **Efficiency, Organization, and Support** to ensure the technical and logistical success of this committee.

I expect a high level of discipline and strategy from every senator. I look forward to seeing how you handle the challenges of this session.

See you on the floor,

Isabella Marullo - Conference Officer

Chapter I - About the United States Congress

The foundations of American legislative authority go back to the **Declaration of Independence** on July 4, 1776. This document marked a significant break from the monarchy and established the idea of popular sovereignty. However, the first attempt at governance under the Articles of Confederation was not effective. This led to the Constitutional Convention of 1787. At this convention, the current U.S. Constitution was created. It shifted from a loose confederacy to a strong federal system. Intense debates took place between Federalists and Anti-Federalists. In the end, they produced a document aimed at forming a more perfect union through a careful balance of shared powers and checks on power.

To ensure the Constitution was ratified and to address concerns about federal overreach, the **Bill of Rights** was adopted in 1791. The first ten amendments guaranteed fundamental rights, including freedom of speech, the right to due process, and protection against illegal searches and seizures. These rights remain binding limits on any legislative action. For this committee, these amendments establish the ultimate legal boundary. No bill proposed by a Clinton administration or passed by this Congress can violate the fundamental rights set during the nation's founding.

The United States Congress serves as the legislative cornerstone of the federal government, deriving its authority directly from **Article I of the Constitution**. It is established as a bicameral legislature, divided into the **House of Representatives** and the **Senate**, a design intended to balance the immediate passions of the electorate with a more stable, deliberative body. The Senate remains the "Upper House," tasked not only with the creation of law but with

the unique responsibilities of confirming executive appointments and ratifying international treaties. This bicameral structure was the result of the "Great Compromise" during the Constitutional Convention of 1787, designed to balance the interests of large and small states. While **Article I, Section 2** defines the House of Representatives as the chamber most responsive to the public through biennial elections, **Article I, Section 3** establishes the Senate as a stabilizing force. The Senate's unique "Advice and Consent" powers, codified in **Article II, Section 2**, grant it the exclusive right to confirm presidential nominees and ratify treaties, effectively making it the gatekeeper of the Executive Branch's agenda. The tension between these two chambers is a defining feature of the American republic, as no piece of legislation can reach the President's desk without passing both houses in identical form.

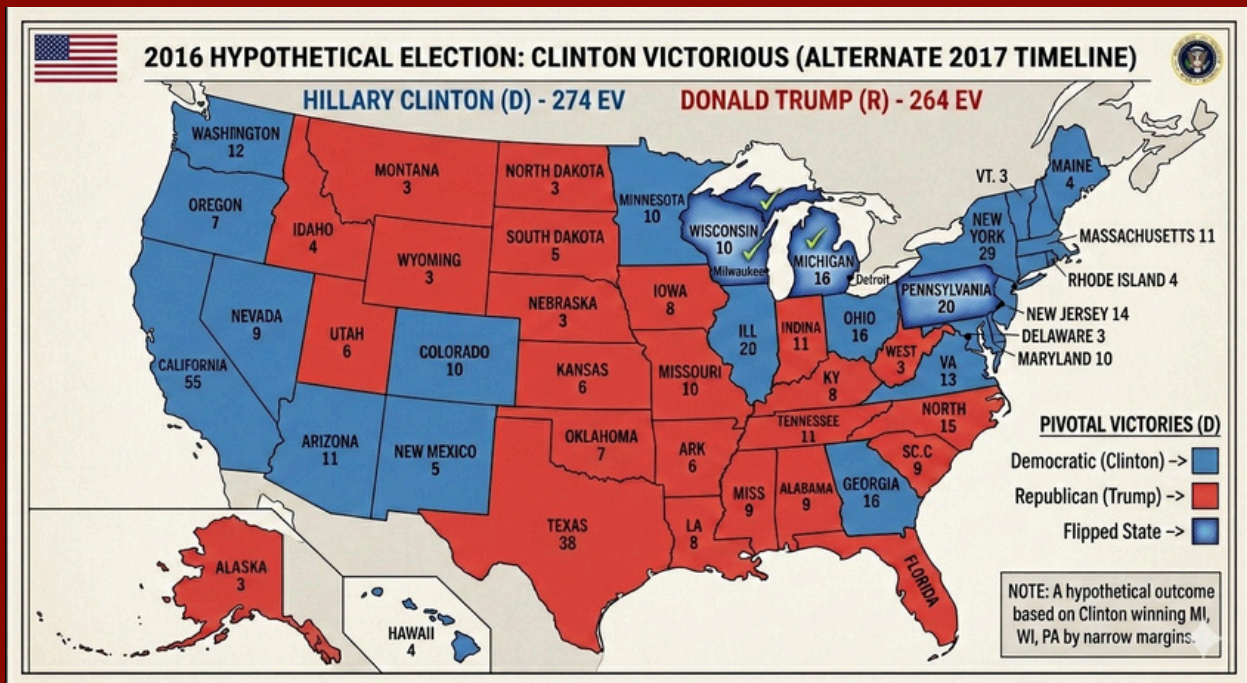
Legislative action within the Senate is governed by complex standing rules that prioritize the rights of the individual Senator over the speed of the majority. The most formidable of these tools is the filibuster, a procedural tactic used to delay or block a vote by extending debate indefinitely. To overcome such an impasse, the Senate must invoke "cloture," a motion requiring a supermajority of three-fifths of the chamber. In this divided 2017, the high threshold for cloture means that the minority party and the Independent bloc possess the power to obstruct any bill they deem radical or unfavorable. Consequently, the art of the "amendment" becomes the primary vehicle for progress, allowing Senators to modify, substitute, or expand upon the House's original bill to secure the necessary consensus.

Chapter II - Congressional Agenda and Current Situation of the Union

The current as of today, **January 24, 2017 (Start date of Session 1)**, political reality was forged on the night of November 8, 2016, in an election decided by **fewer than 110,000 votes** across three pivotal "Blue Wall" states: Pennsylvania, Michigan, and Wisconsin. Unlike the historical timeline, a surge in urban turnout and a late-stage stabilization of polling in the Rust Belt secured **274 electoral votes** for the Clinton-Kaine ticket. However, this victory was not met with national consensus. In the weeks following the election, widespread allegations of **"voter irregularities"** and a series of unsuccessful but highly publicized legal challenges in the Midwest fueled a **"Legitimacy Crisis."**

As of January 2017, internal polling from the Gallup-Alternative index shows that while 274 electoral votes were certified, **42% of the American public believes the "Blue Wall" states (WI, MI, PA) were influenced by foreign cyber-intervention.** This has led to the "November 9th Movement," a series of sustained protests in rural counties that have disrupted interstate commerce.

While President Hillary Clinton was inaugurated on January 20, 2017, as the 45th President, she entered office with the **lowest approval ratings** for an incoming executive in modern history, presiding over a nation where nearly 40% of the electorate viewed the results as fundamentally "not on the level."



As the first female President of the United States, the breaking of the "highest, hardest glass ceiling" in American politics. Her presidency pushes the historical boundaries of the office, redefining gender roles within the executive branch, as well as the continuation of the Democratic Party in rule, with Barack Obama as her predecessor. The essential congressional support for the executive policies is necessary, with strong foreign policy and internal policy.

In the realm of foreign policy, the Clinton administration advocates for "steady, experienced leadership" that reaffirms the United States' role as the primary architect of international order. Central to this vision is the strengthening of ties with NATO and Asia-Pacific allies to counter the rising influence of rival powers. Her strategy includes a hardline stance on global security, specifically a three-part plan to dismantle ISIS infrastructure in Syria and Iraq while increasing the diplomatic and economic costs of Russian aggression. This "principled American leadership"

aims to ensure that the United States remains a decisive force in global affairs, even as it navigates a deeply polarized and skeptical domestic landscape.

As Senators, you must navigate a chamber composed of **50% Democrats, 40% Republicans, and 10% Independents**, where no single bloc holds decisive control. In this environment, governance is not guaranteed; it must be negotiated. The legislative process takes center stage as the Senate receives a bill already passed by the House of Representatives. Delegates must decide whether to:

- Approve the bill,
- Amend it through additions or substitutions
- Or block it entirely.

Internally, the administration's agenda focuses on expanding the **socio-economic reach of the federal government**. This includes a robust push for the *"American Opportunity and Infrastructure Act,"* [annex document to this study guide under ANNEX 1], which aims to modernize the nation's transit and energy grids while installing 500 million solar panels to combat climate change. Her domestic platform also prioritizes economic equity through proposals for a higher minimum wage, equal pay for women, and the implementation of debt-free college programs. Furthermore, she seeks to stabilize and expand the *Patient Protection and Affordable Care Act (ACA)* while advocating for universal pre-kindergarten and comprehensive **immigration reform** that provides a pathway to citizenship.

The United States Senate now finds itself at the center of an intense legislative confrontation, as it assumes responsibility for evaluating a series of bills transmitted by the House of Representatives. At the forefront of this agenda stands **H.R. 101, the American Opportunity and Infrastructure Act**, a comprehensive proposal that seeks to allocate unprecedented federal funding toward the modernization of national infrastructure, expansion of clean energy initiatives, and promotion of economic opportunity. While proponents argue that such investment is essential to stimulate growth and address long-standing structural deficiencies, opponents raise significant concerns regarding the scale of public spending and the mechanisms proposed to finance it.

However, the debate surrounding H.R. 101 extends far beyond its immediate policy provisions. At its core, the bill has become a symbolic battleground for broader ideological disputes regarding the role of the federal government in shaping economic and social outcomes. For many Senators, the legislation represents a necessary intervention to address systemic inefficiencies, regional disparities, and the long-term sustainability of national infrastructure. For others, it embodies an **overextension of federal authority**, raising concerns about bureaucratic expansion, fiscal irresponsibility, and the potential displacement of private sector initiative.

This tension is further exacerbated by the **fragile political legitimacy** of the executive branch. The contested nature of the 2016 election has created an environment in which legislative cooperation is not only politically costly but also strategically risky. Senators must therefore balance policy considerations with electoral accountability, recognizing that their decisions will be scrutinized by constituents who remain deeply divided in their perception of the

current administration. In this sense, every vote cast on H.R. 101 is not merely a legislative action, but a political statement regarding the direction and legitimacy of federal governance.

Compounding these challenges is the procedural complexity of the Senate itself. Unlike the House of Representatives, where majorities can more easily assert control, the Senate operates under rules that empower minority factions and encourage extended debate. Mechanisms such as the **filibuster and cloture** transform the legislative process into a test of endurance and negotiation, requiring not only numerical support but also strategic coordination. As a result, the success of H.R. 101 will depend not solely on its substantive merits but on the ability of its proponents to navigate the institutional constraints of the chamber.

Chapter III - Recommendations and Essential Information

At the start of each session, the Dais will introduce a list of **five legislative documents** as part of the Formal Agenda. From that list, the Senate must fully act on **AT LEAST TWO** before the session ends. “Acting” means you must reach a clear outcome, pass, reject, or amend the bill, or any other action that the Senators view as appropriate, as long as it is previously approved by the President of the Senate. This creates constant pressure to move debate forward, so delegates need to think strategically about which proposals to prioritize. You will not have time to fully debate everything, so focus on what you can realistically move through the chamber.

Amendments are the main tool delegates will use to shape incoming bills. Since the bill is broad and controversial, it is expected that most progress in this committee will come through modifications rather than accepting or rejecting the bill as a whole.

Be aware that session dates and pacing will change. The committee formally starts on **January 24, 2017**, and dates will move; you should be flexible and ready to adjust quickly. Be aware when mentioning dates, information, or any other aspect in speech/documents, as this may be influential for your evaluation. Please remember that **EVERYTHING after the indicated day is NOT EXISTENT** under the scope of this Congress. The information on Chapter II of this document references the State of the Union relevant for your action in this committee. Come into each session prepared to speak and react immediately, as timelines may shift and debates can move faster than expected.

Controversial political speech is FULLY ENCOURAGED and expected. This committee reflects a highly polarized political environment, and strong positions on divisive issues will drive the debate. Do not avoid difficult topics, but please remember to **stay school-appropriate**. In case the senators would like to mention any specific topic outside the ones provided by the Formal Agenda, please address any member of the Senate Dais.

Senators should **actively use and cite the U.S. Constitution and other Legislation** in their arguments. Whether you support or oppose H.R. 101 and other of the introduced legislation, grounding your position in constitutional principles will make your case stronger. Think about federal authority, limits of government power, and how different interpretations can support your stance.

You must also understand the **ongoing tension between state governments and the federal government**. For example, many aspects of H.R. 101 raise questions about whether decisions should be made nationally or left to the states. Use this conflict to strengthen your arguments and differentiate your position.

Most importantly, **you are representing a real political figure, NOT YOUR personal views**. You are expected to research your assigned representative in advance and clearly understand their party affiliation, voting history, and policy positions. There should be a clear distinction in how Republican and Democratic delegates approach issues, and the way in which the Senators represent their constituents. Your speeches, amendments, and voting decisions

should reflect your representative's beliefs and political strategy, even if they differ from your own opinions.

Finally, **be strategic**. The 115th Congress faces a massive legislative workload ranging from **economic relief** and **climate action** to **national security** and **immigration reform**. Success in this committee is not just about making strong speeches; it is about getting results. Build alliances, negotiate amendments, and be willing to compromise when necessary. Pay attention to the balance of power in the chamber and adapt your approach. Delegates who combine deep research into these diverse policy areas with smart negotiation will be the most effective.

God bless the United States, and let the session begin...

(ANNEX 1) - OFFICIAL COMMUNICATION

FROM: The House of Representatives

TO: The Senate of the United States

DATE: January 24, 2017

SUBJECT: H.R. 101 — American Opportunity and Infrastructure Act of 2017

The following Act, having been passed by the House of Representatives on January 23, 2017, is hereby transmitted to the Senate for its advice, consent, and deliberation.

AN ACT

To provide for a significant investment in the national infrastructure of the United States, to promote economic opportunity through job creation, to modernize energy grids, and to ensure the long-term sustainability of the American economy.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives of the United States of America in Congress assembled,

SECTION 1. SHORT TITLE.

This Act may be cited as the "*American Opportunity and Infrastructure Act of 2017.*"

SECTION 2. FINDINGS.

The Congress finds the following:

The American Society of Civil Engineers has evaluated the national infrastructure with a cumulative grade of "D+," identifying urgent requirements for the repair of bridges, dams, and public transit systems. The expansion of the national electrical grid is a matter of national security and a prerequisite for the transition to a sustainable, low-carbon economy. Persistent

economic stagnation in rural and post-industrial regions necessitates a federal mandate for job creation and wage stabilization.

SECTION 3. INFRASTRUCTURE MODERNIZATION AND TRANSPORTATION.

(a) ALLOCATION OF FUNDS: There is authorized to be appropriated \$500,000,000,000 for the fiscal years 2017 through 2022 to be administered by the Department of Transportation for the repair of Federal-aid highways and structural bridge restoration.

(b) UNIVERSAL BROADBAND: The Secretary of Commerce shall establish the "Rural Broadband Grant Program" to ensure high-speed fiber-optic access for 98% of American households by the conclusion of the 2020 fiscal year.

SECTION 4. CLEAN ENERGY INITIATIVES.

(a) SOLAR CAPACITY: It is the established goal of the federal government to facilitate the installation of 500,000,000 solar panels within the United States by the end of the current presidential term.

(b) SMART GRID TECHNOLOGY: \$100,000,000,000 shall be allocated to the Department of Energy for the development of "Smart Grid" infrastructure to optimize energy distribution and mitigate carbon emissions.

SECTION 5. WORKFORCE AND EDUCATION.

(a) DEBT-FREE HIGHER EDUCATION: The Secretary of Education is directed to provide federal grants to States to ensure that resident students may attend in-state public colleges and universities without the accrual of student loan debt.

(b) VOCATIONAL TRAINING: \$10,000,000,000 is authorized for competitive grants to support vocational training and registered apprenticeship programs specifically targeting the infrastructure and renewable energy sectors.

SECTION 6. FISCAL PROVISIONS AND FUNDING.

(a) REVENUE GENERATION: To offset the budgetary requirements of this Act, the Secretary of the Treasury shall implement a reform of corporate tax structures, specifically targeting overseas profits and closing loopholes regarding corporate inversions.

(b) NATIONAL INFRASTRUCTURE BANK: There is hereby established a National Infrastructure Bank to provide low-interest loans and credit enhancement for regional and state projects of significant national importance.

SECTION 7. EFFECTIVE DATE.

This Act shall take effect 30 days after the date of its enactment by the President of the United States.

Attest:

(Signed)

Karen L. Haas

Clerk of the House of Representatives

Note for Delegates:

This bill was passed by the House of Representatives with a narrow majority. As Senators, you must now decide whether to move for Cloture to end debate, or to propose Amendments that satisfy the 50% Democratic, 40% Republican, and 10% Independent factions. Failure to reconcile this text with the House version will result in the bill's expiration.

BIBLIOGRAPHY:

- *FullText oftheU.S. Constitution* | Constitution Center. (2026). National Constitution Center – Constitutioncenter.Org. <https://constitutioncenter.org/the-constitution/full-text>
- *Issues Archive - The Office of Hillary Rodham Clinton*. (2016). The Office of Hillary Rodham Clinton. <https://www.hillaryclinton.com/issues/>
- *Hillary Clinton's presidential campaign, 2016*. (2016). Ballotpedia. https://ballotpedia.org/Hillary_Clinton_presidential_campaign_2016
- *The Amending Process in the Senate*. (2025). Congress.Gov. <https://www.congress.gov/crs-product/98-853>
- *Home | Senate Democratic Leadership*. (2025). Senate.Gov; The Senate Democratic Caucus. <https://www.democrats.senate.gov/>
- *Home - Senate Republican Conference*. (2026, May 11). Senate Republican Conference. <https://www.republican.senate.gov/>
- *Department Reports and Publications - United States Department of State*. (2026, April 24). United States Department of State. <https://www.state.gov/department-reports/>
- *U.S. Congress. (2010, March 23). H.R.3590 - 111th congress (2009-2010): Patient protection and affordable care act*. Congress.Gov. <https://www.congress.gov/bill/111th-congress/house-bill/3590>
- *Adams, C. (2016, December 23). 16 stories that defined 2016*. Cbsnews.Com. <https://www.cbsnews.com/news/16-stories-that-defined-2016/>
- *Helping to Restore Water Infrastructure to Iraqi Town Liberated from ISIS - United States Department of State*. (2020, December). United States Department of State.

<https://2017-2021.state.gov/helping-to-restore-water-infrastructure-to-iraqi-town-liberated-from-isis/>

- *FY 2016 Budget Fact Sheet | US Department of Transportation.* (2016).

Transportation.Gov.

<https://www.transportation.gov/mission/budget/fy-2016-budget-fact-sheet>

- *Climate Action Report.* (2017). State.Gov.

<https://2009-2017.state.gov/e/oes/climate/climateactionreport/index.htm>